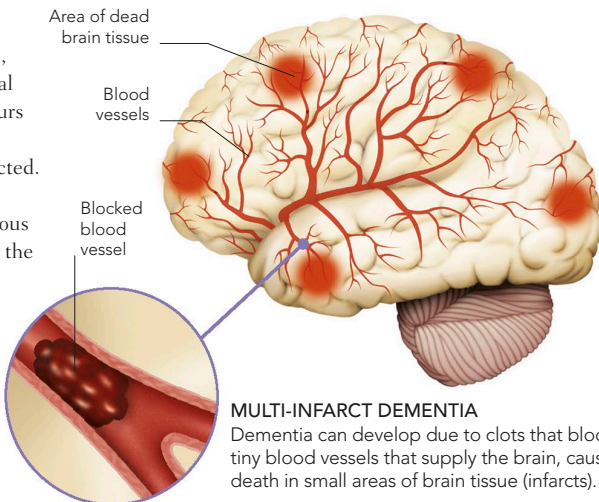


DEMENTIA

Dementia combines memory loss, confusion, and general intellectual decline. The disorder mainly occurs in people over the age of 65, but young people are sometimes affected. In the early stages of dementia, a person is prone to becoming anxious or depressed due to awareness of the memory loss. As the dementia worsens, the person may become more dependent on others and may eventually need full-time care in a nursing home. Carers may also need support.

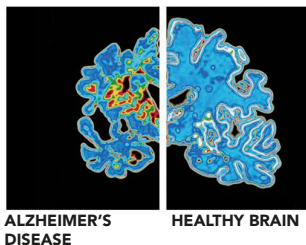


MULTI-INFARCT DEMENTIA

Dementia can develop due to clots that block tiny blood vessels that supply the brain, causing death in small areas of brain tissue (infarcts).

ALZHEIMER'S DISEASE

The most common form of dementia is Alzheimer's disease. Brain damage occurs due to the abnormal production of a protein called amyloid, which builds up in the brain. No cure has been found, but drugs can slow the progress of the disease in some people.



BRAIN IN ALZHEIMER'S DISEASE

This computer graphic shows a slice through the brain of a person with Alzheimer's disease compared to a slice of healthy brain. The diseased brain is considerably shrunken due to the degeneration and death of nerve cells. The surface of a brain affected by Alzheimer's disease may be more deeply folded than normal.

MIGRAINE

About 1 in 10 people has migraine, with episodes of severe headache often associated with visual disturbances, nausea, and vomiting. The underlying cause of a migraine is unknown, but changes in the diameter of the blood vessels in the scalp and brain are known to occur. Current research indicates that migraine is linked to abnormal function of nerve pathways and a disturbance in the activity of brain chemicals. Triggers for a migraine attack include stress, missed meals, lack of sleep, and certain foods, such as cheese or chocolate. In many women, migraines are associated with menstruation.

HEADACHE PHASE

During migraine, severe, throbbing pain may affect half or all of the head as blood vessels in the scalp and brain widen (dilate). These vascular changes are thought to be secondary to nerve pathway abnormalities.

